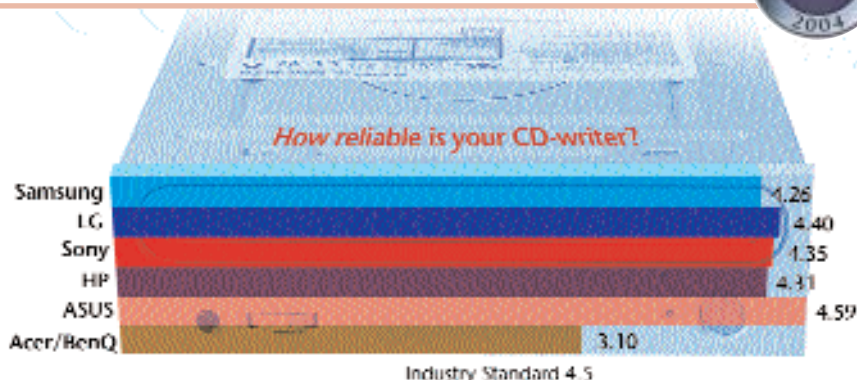


CD-Writers

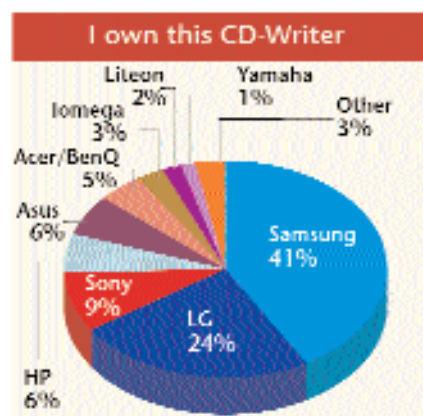
Winner for CD-Writers is **LG**



A few months ago, we discontinued testing CD-ROM-only drives, deciding to instead test CD-Writers and other so-called combo-drives. With a CD-Writer priced at almost the same price as a solitary read-only drive, we reasoned that consumers would stop purchasing the latter, and opt for combo-drives and CD-Writers instead. Results of the survey back that reasoning, as a healthy 940 votes rang for CD-Writers.



Performance of **Acer/BenQ** CD-Writer drives was the **Worst** in terms of consumer **Satisfaction**



Of the number, Samsung took the biggest piece of the pie with a count of 404, while LG came in second with 233; it was a race similar to the one fought on the computer display front. Here, however, the base number of more than 900 ensured that Sony, HP, ASUS and BenQ got more than five per cent of share.

ASUS came across as the most reliable drive, and was top dog on the Reliability Index, followed some distance away by LG. Consumer satisfaction with technical personnel in service centres, and with repair or replacement of defective prod-

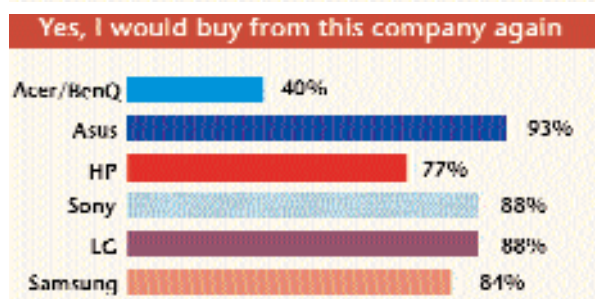
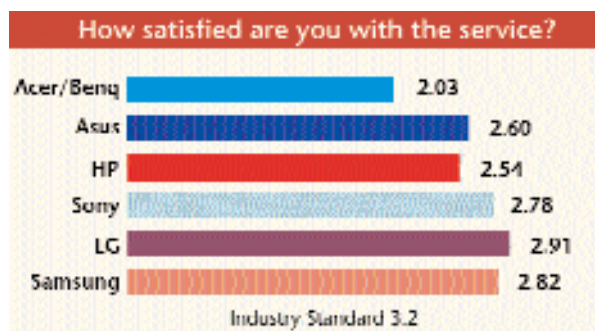
ly open and close the tray." Similar responses of "excellent writing quality but poor build quality", "I got tray problems", and "disk gets stuck while inserting" echo for ASUS and Samsung as well. The lens is also a problem area. While some brave souls clean the lens by removing the cover of their drive (and instantly voiding their warranty in the process), others are forced to replace their drives since a lens costs half the price of the drive.

Sony came under fire from more than one reader for its lacklustre after-sales support. Ravi Pherwani opined, "Sony is one of the most trusted names in this industry today, but it needs more efficient service management". Vidhu Bhushan, a professor from Mumbai, complained, "The distributors of Sony products show a lot of indifference in dealing with the customer." Harsha, himself a technical support personnel says, "Sony India products are sub-standard. Their imported products are far better than the ones manufactured here. It will be better if Sony can improve the quality of products manufactured and sold here."

On the software front, there were minor niggles concerning drivers and some complaints on the choice of software provided with the drives, with one reader stating that he prefers Nero Burning ROM to the software supplied.

A very sensitive CD-drive! The tray is a nightmare for everyone... gets misaligned...

Ashish, on his Samsung CD-Writer
New Delhi



ucts earned LG the top-spot. Samsung earned the second rank in terms of service, underscoring the importance of good after-sales support and service centre coverage.

The most common cause of customer woe was mechanical problem with the tray of a drive. Manu Sekhri, a student from Mumbai, pointed out, "Acer should make the product more reliable. The Writer I have is two and half years old, and although it writes fine, the tray is not working. I have to manual-

MOST RELIABLE CD-WRITER: ASUS RUNNER-UP: LG Electronics
MOST SATISFACTORY SERVICE: LG Electronics RUNNER-UP: Samsung